

NEWSLETTER

SJBEF is an Affiliate of Catholic Financial Life

2024



Seminarian scholarship checks presented to the Shrine of Our Lady of LaSalette in Attleboro, MA.

Dear Fraternal Brothers and Sisters,

I am pleased to provide you with an update on the Saint-Jean-Baptiste Educational Foundation (SJBEF) 2024 results.

I first want to thank all those that have made donations to the Foundation through the years. Your continued support is greatly appreciated not only by the Trustees but especially by all of the New England members, seminarians and Catholic schools that benefit from the SJBEF scholarships and grants. All of which are made possible in part through your donations and through Catholic Financial Life (CFL) chapter match funds.

Our Member Scholarships remained at the increased level of \$1,000 each and the number of applications remained the same as in 2023. Our Seminarian Scholarships also remained at last year's increased level of \$900, with even greater participation. We celebrated the 70th Annual Pilgrimage at La Salette on September 8, and it was a huge success. The Foundation also continues to present two \$800 scholarships to the Shrine of Our Lady of La Salette.

In 2023 we introduced a new Grant/Scholarship Program for Catholic elementary, middle, and high schools in New England. This program was well received and continued in 2024. We have again received nominations from 75% of the New England chapters. The Trustees voted to increase the grants to \$600 each this year. These grants are a way for the Foundation to continue to strengthen educational opportunities for our youth.

I would like to thank you again for your continued support of the SJBEF. I would also like to thank all the SJBEF Trustees and CFL Home Office for supporting the Foundation.

Wishing all the very best.

Bruce Laverriere

SJBEF Chair

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2024 AWARD HIGHLIGHTS

Paul Pinsonnault

This year the Trustees were able to continue funding initiatives made last year. These awards include the following:

College Scholarships

For the second year in a row 32 scholarships were awarded to students. Recipients were from each New England state except for Connecticut, with 19 being from Massachusetts, seven from Maine, three from Rhode Island, two from New Hampshire and one from Vermont. Resources allowed the awards to be \$1,000. The trustees congratulate the recipients and wish them another successful year.

Massachusetts Madeleine Brodeur, Noelle Champigny, Alexander Cormier, Brenna Dushinsky, Maeve Dujardin, Cecilia Eluszkiewicz, Joseph Eluszkiewicz, Victoria Eluszkiewicz, Brooke Forget, Ella Gesner, Connor Grew, Monique Grew, Jack Hebert, Nicole Ledwidge, Laren O'Donald, Rachel Perry, Jason Pinsonnault, Caroline Puccini, Sophia Puccini **Maine** Alexander Bryant, Lucy Frenette, Miles Frenette, Makenzie Parent, Zoe Petit, Emmanjuelle Richie, Lauren Theriault **New Hampshire** Audrey Pilotte, Tyler Young **Rhode Island** Ellie Buttarro, Julia Raymond, Carl Schneider **Vermont** Nicole Dirmaier

Seminarian Scholarships

Seminarians from ten New England Dioceses were awarded scholarships. Each Diocese was offered \$900 to be distributed to either one or two seminarians. The Providence Diocese has an additional award of \$1,000 which is made in honor of Bishop Louis Gelineau. In addition, two scholarships were allocated to the LaSalette Order for those studying for the LaSalette Priesthood and Brotherhood.



Chapter N012 Southbridge, MA presents a grant to All Saints Academy.



Chapter N042 North Attleboro, MA presents a grant to St. Mary/Sacred Heart School.

Grants

For the second year, resources were available to continue awarding grants to a Catholic elementary, middle or high school as recommended by local chapters. A total of 17 Grants in the amount of \$600 each were issued, with presentations to be made by chapter leaders.

French Awards

As the Foundation has had generous contributions made by members to assist in the studies of the French language, two scholarships will be awarded again this year. These presentations will be made to students studying French at Providence College.



Chapter N084 Gardner, MA presents a grant to Holy Family Academy.



Chapter N091 Manchester, NH presents a grant to St. Joseph Junior High School.



Scholarship recipients from Chapters N042, N441 and N442



Chapter N441 Westport, MA presents a grant to St. Theresa of Calcutta School.

Foundation Financial Report

Ken Boivin

Through all the turmoil of the past year the Foundation is still on solid ground. The Chicago Trust Company, together with Great Lakes Advisors LLC, continue handling our investments wisely. They have grown our investments to over \$2.5 million dollars.

Through your generosity the 2024 fundraising campaign brought in \$6,182. Our 2025 fundraising campaign is about to get underway and we are hoping that you will again bless the Foundation with your generosity. Remember the Foundation is a 501c3 organization and your donation is tax deductible.

As you know, our mission is to raise funds for scholarships and grants. We do this through our fundraisers and our investment income. So far this year, we have awarded \$32,000 in College Scholarships and will be giving away an additional \$24,850 in the form of Seminarian Scholarships, French Scholarships and Catholic School Grants. The Seminarian Scholarship

recipients are chosen by the various dioceses throughout New England, while the French Scholarships are awarded to students taking French as a major or minor and are chosen by Providence College. The names of the Catholic schools receiving grants are chosen by the New England chapters.

The Trustees have made an operational change this year, as I have moved to Florida. The Post Office Box in Worcester has been closed and a new one opened in Woonsocket (P.O. Box 275, Woonsocket, RI 02895) for donations. Paul Plante will monitor the P.O. Box, deposit any checks and email me the total for my records. I will continue to write the checks, provide the Trustees with quarterly reports and provide any financial information to the Home Office in Milwaukee.

If anyone has any questions about the Foundation's finances feel free to contact me at ken.boivin22@gmail.com.